Dawa.[38] In the past, such Pakistani actions have been mostly cosmetic; in the wake of government crackdowns, terror organizations have changed their names and quickly resumed their activities.[39] Therefore, it remains to be seen whether Islamabad's current policy will have any lasting impact. Given the track record of past Pakistani governments, it seems doubtful that the fledgling democratic regime of President Asif Ali Zardari will have the ability or interest needed to move seriously against the militants. But only time will tell.

The Indians, for their part, must start to take their own security more seriously. In 1991, after suffering a major financial crisis, the Indian government came to terms with the failures of its socialist development model and adopted a new, free-market approach to economic growth. India must use the Mumbai crisis to wholly revamp its security infrastructure. The Indians appear to have begun this process. Soon after the attacks the government announced that it was enhancing its maritime security capabilities, creating an FBI-like National Investigative Agency, increasing intelligence sharing, improving the training and equipment of police and domestic security forces, and strengthening antiterrorism laws.[40] The Indians must follow through on these initiatives. In addition, they must address the legitimate concerns of their own Muslim community, including the long-aggrieved Kashmiri population, so that overseas terrorists do not find willing collaborators within India. If they fail to take these steps, the country's impressive military and economic gains of recent years will be for naught. Sophisticated conventional military capabilities, and even a nuclear arsenal, mean little when ordinary citizens are not safe from the threat of gunmen in the railway stations, streets, hospitals, and hotels of their own cities. And in the absence of major security improvements, international corporations will lose interest in India, viewing the country as excessively dangerous and refusing to do business there.

None of the steps outlined above will provide an overnight solution to the problems laid bare by the Mumbai attacks. But, in time, they can help South Asia create its own modern-day sorcerer, dealing with the militant forces that Pakistan has unleashed over recent decades without triggering a large-scale war or nuclear